

The Resurrection is happening now ... and later.

Thomas Sunday

Happiness and sadness, with expectation.

"A Little Bit" - 2018-04-21

The Resurrection has to be looked at realistically, from two perspectives. Number one, **The Resurrection is happening now, within us**¹. I talk about that all the time because I don't think we live like that, but the Resurrection is truly transcendent and should affect everything you do, everything you say, everything you are, should be affected by the Resurrection.

But also, we are like Thomas². **There are parts of us that are not quite affected by the Resurrection yet.** There is still darkness in us. There is still confusion. There's still anger and passion and all kinds of stuff. The Resurrection is supposed to fix all that, and it will. It doesn't happen immediately to the Apostle Thomas. It doesn't even happen completely on the day of Pentecost. It happens through our lifetime of struggle. Thomas's healing, which took only eight days, is a promise that we will also receive healing, not likely in eight days, but healing will come.

So that's what I mean by being realistic about the Resurrection. We can't just say it's Pascha, "Christ is risen", happy, happy, happy. Because there's still things in us that should make us not very happy. What should make us happy is that *they can be solved. They can be changed.*

Tags: A little bit; Resurrection; Thomas Sunday; Healing;

The Orthodox Christian faith is full of life-giving truth, but it is also very complex and even overwhelming to beginners. It is not at all like the typical Western expression of Christianity, and this is part of the reason why it is so overwhelming and seems too big to many people. These small postings are in attempt to give "**A Little Bit**" of knowledge and edification regarding Orthodox Christianity. Since they come from my mind, they are not necessarily organized, but they are absolutely from the heart. It may be very hard to learn all the fasting rules and to go to long services and to read the Fathers, or even the Bible, but it is not so hard to read or listen to or watch a short video about something that is just "**A Little Bit**" about Christianity. Please send suggestions for other topics, and comments. [Priest Seraphim Holland](mailto:seraphim@orthodox.net), (seraphim@orthodox.net) who is learning a little bit each day about how to be a real Christian.

Source: <http://www.orthodox.net/a-little-bit/alb-happiness-thomas-and-the-resurrection.pdf> , <http://www.orthodox.net/a-little-bit/alb-happiness-thomas-and-the-resurrection.doc>

Originally from: <https://www.facebook.com/priestseraphim.holland/posts/3815464626740>

¹ Cf. Luke 17:20-21 "And when he was demanded of the Pharisees, when the kingdom of God should come, he answered them and said, The kingdom of God cometh not with observation: (21) Neither shall they say, Lo here! or, lo there! for, behold, the kingdom of God is within you."

² The Story of St Thomas is read on "Thomas Sunday", the Second S Sunday of Pascha (the Sunday right after Pascha). It would be very good to read this story: John 20:19-31. BASIC SUMMARY: Thomas was not able to believe in the resurrection, but he stayed with those who did, until the 8th day of Pascha when the Lord appeared to him and Thomas believed and said: "My Lord my God".